

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an article about constructing a ferris wheel:

The government is going ahead with the construction of a giant ferris wheel on the Central waterfront. The wheel will reach 60 metres into the sky, carrying passengers in air-conditioned gondolas. It is estimated that about 2,000 people will ride on weekdays and 4,000 on weekends and public holidays. Each ride could last 10 to 15 minutes, with a fare of about HK\$100.

Supporters of the plan say that Hong Kong would benefit from adding a ferris wheel to its skyline. "It will offer a unique experience that both locals and tourists can enjoy."

But not everyone is convinced that a ferris wheel will be good for Hong Kong. Lawmaker Paul Tse stressed Hong Kong has very few tourist spots along the coast and that the Central waterfront is a prime location and very expensive. Hong Kong already has very good observation points on The Peak and Sky100 in Kowloon, where people can enjoy the view from both sides of the harbour.

His concerns are echoed in part by Paul Zimmerman of the Society for the Protection of the Harbour. He feels that Hong Kong should not be seen as a 'copycat' simply mimicking the London Eye and the Singapore Flyer, two ferris wheels which are bigger than the one proposed to be built in Hong Kong. "I would rather the land is used for waterfront restaurants or a kids' playground."



Your group is discussing the proposed construction of a ferris wheel on the Central waterfront. You may want to talk about:

- whether Hong Kong needs a tourist attraction along the waterfront
- whether a ferris wheel would be an ideal tourist attraction
- how the land could be developed for other purposes
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to ride a ferris wheel?
2. Do you think that riding a ferris wheel is fun?
3. Would you rather ride a ferris wheel during the day or at night?
4. Would you pay HK\$100 to ride a ferris wheel to see Hong Kong's harbour?
5. Do you think a ferris wheel in Hong Kong will be successful?
6. Do you agree that the best tourist attraction in Hong Kong is its harbour?
7. Do you think that the ferris wheel should be a temporary or a permanent attraction?
8. Do you agree that Hong Kong is always copying other cities?